

New Client Intake

General outpatient therapy template - complete electronically or print clearly



Practice information

Practice / clinician name

Date

Phone

Email

Client information

Legal name

Preferred name

Date of birth

Age

Pronouns

Gender identity

Street address

City

State

ZIP code

Phone

Email

Preferred contact method

☐

Phone

☐

Text

☐

Email

☐

Client portal

May the practice leave a voicemail identifying itself?

☐

Yes

☐

No

Emergency contact

Name

Relationship

Phone

Parent / guardian, if applicable

Name

Relationship

Phone

Presenting Concerns and Goals

Describe what brings you to therapy and what you hope will change



Reason for seeking therapy

What concerns or circumstances led you to seek therapy now?

When did these concerns begin, and how have they changed over time?

Current concerns

Check all that apply

- | | | |
|---|--|---|
| ☐ Anxiety / worry | ☐ Low mood | ☐ Panic symptoms |
| ☐ Trauma reactions | ☐ Grief / loss | ☐ Anger / irritability |
| ☐ Mood changes | ☐ Sleep problems | ☐ Eating concerns |
| ☐ Attention / focus | ☐ Relationship conflict | ☐ Family stress |
| ☐ Work / school stress | ☐ Substance use | ☐ Compulsive behavior |
| ☐ Self-esteem | ☐ Identity concerns | ☐ Life transition |
| ☐ Chronic pain / illness | ☐ Other | |

If other, please describe

Impact and goals

How much are these concerns affecting daily functioning?

- ☐ Not at all ☐ Mildly ☐ Moderately ☐ Severely

What are your main goals for therapy?

What has helped, even a little? Include coping skills, supports, or prior strategies.

Mental Health History

Include prior counseling, diagnoses, crises, and treatment response



Previous services

Have you previously received counseling, psychotherapy, or psychiatric care?

☐

Yes

☐

No

Provider / program and approximate dates

What was helpful or unhelpful about prior treatment?

Diagnoses and higher levels of care

Current or past mental health diagnoses, if any

Any psychiatric hospitalization, crisis, residential care, or intensive outpatient care?

☐

Yes

☐

No

If yes, describe when, where, and the reason

Symptoms experienced in the past

Check any that have occurred, even if not current

- ☐ Prolonged depression
- ☐ Traumatic event
- ☐ Elevated / energized mood
- ☐ Hallucinations
- ☐ Disordered eating
- ☐ Attention difficulties

- ☐ Severe anxiety / panic
- ☐ Flashbacks / nightmares
- ☐ Little need for sleep
- ☐ Paranoia
- ☐ Compulsive behavior
- ☐ Memory concerns

Additional details, approximate dates, triggers, or patterns

Family mental health history

Mental health, substance use, suicide, or psychiatric treatment history in biological relatives

Medical and Medication History

Share information that may affect emotional health or treatment planning



Health care contacts

Primary care clinician

Phone

May care be coordinated after a separate written authorization?

☐

Yes

☐

No

Current health

Medical conditions, chronic pain, pregnancy, recent illness, or major injuries

Medication or other allergies and reactions

Sleep quality

☐

Good

☐

Fair

☐

Poor

Average hours / night

Appetite

☐

Stable

☐

Increased

☐

Decreased

Medications and supplements

List prescriptions, over-the-counter products, vitamins, and supplements. Include dose, frequency, reason, and prescriber.

Medication

Dose / frequency

Reason / prescriber

Medication

Dose / frequency

Reason / prescriber

Medication

Dose / frequency

Reason / prescriber

Medication

Dose / frequency

Reason / prescriber

Daily functioning

☐ Independent with daily needs

☐ Needs some assistance

☐ Major recent change in functioning

Explain limitations, accommodations, or accessibility needs

Substance Use and Wellness

Responses support safe, nonjudgmental treatment planning



Current and past use

For each item, note current frequency and amount, last use, and any past periods of heavier use or concern.

Alcohol	
Cannabis	
Nicotine / vaping	
Medication not as directed	
Stimulants	
Opioids	
Sedatives	
Other substances	

Effects and recovery

Has substance use caused concern, affected responsibilities, or led to risky situations?

☐

Yes

☐

No

If yes, describe concerns, treatment, supports, overdose history, or withdrawal symptoms

Wellness and routines

Exercise, nutrition, spiritual practices, hobbies, and restorative routines

Sleep schedule and factors that affect sleep

Legal or behavioral concerns

Legal matters, violence, impulsive behavior, or other concerns relevant to treatment

Family, Relationships, and Daily Life

Share only what you are comfortable discussing today



Household and relationships

Who lives with you? Include relationships and caregiving responsibilities.

Important relationships, supports, conflicts, or recent changes

Education and employment

Education, current school or training, and learning needs

Work status, occupation, workplace stress, or financial concerns

Background and identity

Cultural, racial, ethnic, religious, gender, sexuality, disability, or community identities important to care

Significant childhood, developmental, family, military, immigration, or life experiences

Strengths and preferences

Strengths, interests, values, resources, and people you can rely on

Preferences, accommodations, or topics to approach carefully

Suicide and self-harm

Current thoughts of suicide or not wanting to live

☐ Yes

☐ No

Suicide thoughts at any time in the past

☐ Yes

☐ No

Current plan, intent, preparation, or access to intended means

☐ Yes

☐ No

Past suicide attempt or interrupted / aborted attempt

☐ Yes

☐ No

Current urge to injure yourself without suicidal intent

☐ Yes

☐ No

Past nonsuicidal self-injury

☐ Yes

☐ No

If yes, describe timing, frequency, plan, intent, means, attempts, care received, and what stopped you

Harm to others and interpersonal safety

Current thoughts, intent, plan, or preparation to harm another person?

☐ Yes

☐ No

Are you being threatened, abused, stalked, controlled, or made to feel unsafe?

☐ Yes

☐ No

If yes, describe immediate concerns and anyone else who may be at risk

Protective factors and immediate plan

Reasons for living, supports, coping skills, responsibilities, and safe places

Access to firearms, large medication quantities, or other lethal means; note safety steps

Clinician use: risk assessment, consultation, safety plan, referral, emergency action, and follow-up

Informed Consent for Therapy

Read carefully and ask the clinician about anything that is unclear



Nature of therapy

Psychotherapy is a collaborative process intended to support emotional health, functioning, insight, and behavior change. Benefits cannot be guaranteed. Therapy may involve difficult experiences and can temporarily increase distress. Alternatives may include another clinician, a different approach, medication evaluation, group services, community supports, or no treatment.

Confidentiality and its limits

Information shared in therapy is generally confidential. Exceptions may apply when disclosure is required or permitted by law, including suspected abuse or neglect, serious risk of harm, certain court orders, health oversight, emergencies, or other legally defined circumstances. The clinician will explain applicable limits. Insurance billing and coordination may require limited information with authorization or as otherwise permitted by law.

Emergencies and electronic communication

Routine email, text, voicemail, and client portals may not be continuously monitored and may carry privacy risks. They should not be used for emergencies. The practice must provide its crisis and after-hours procedure. Telehealth can involve technology and privacy risks; safeguards, location requirements, backup plans, and emergency procedures should be reviewed before telehealth sessions.

Records, consultation, and coordination

The practice maintains clinical and billing records as required by law and policy. Clinicians may consult with supervisors or other professionals while limiting identifying information when possible. Information may be shared with others only with a valid authorization or as allowed or required by law. Clients may ask how to access, amend, restrict, or obtain copies of records, subject to applicable law.

Client choice and treatment changes

Participation is voluntary unless treatment is court ordered or subject to another legal condition. Clients may ask questions, request changes, decline a recommendation, seek a second opinion, or end therapy. The clinician may recommend referral, a higher level of care, or termination when needs exceed scope, safety requires more support, practice policies are not met, or treatment is no longer beneficial.

Acknowledgment

I have had the opportunity to ask questions. I understand that this template does not replace the practice's full Notice of Privacy Practices or state-specific informed consent. My signature below indicates consent to evaluation and treatment under the finalized practice policies provided to me.

Consent to Treatment at Cambridge Psychiatry

I voluntarily agree to be seen, evaluated, and treated at Cambridge Psychiatry. I have reviewed the informed consent information above, had an opportunity to ask questions, and authorize Cambridge Psychiatry to provide behavioral health services to me.

Patient signature

Date

Printed patient name

Acknowledgments and Signatures

Sign after reviewing the completed practice policies and asking questions



Client acknowledgments

- ☐ The information I provided is accurate to the best of my knowledge.
- ☐ I received and reviewed the practice's finalized informed consent and office policies.
- ☐ I received or was offered the practice's Notice of Privacy Practices.
- ☐ I understand confidentiality and its limits.
- ☐ I understand how to seek emergency help and that routine messages are not crisis services.
- ☐ I understand fees, billing, cancellation, and no-show policies.
- ☐ I consent to evaluation and psychotherapy services and may ask questions or withdraw consent.

Signatures

Client signature (type full legal name if signing electronically)

Date

Relationship to client, if not self

Parent / guardian signature, if applicable

Date

Clinician signature

Date

Clinician use

Initial impression, strengths, needs, and factors requiring follow-up

Initial plan, referrals, coordination, next appointment, and measures to complete

Disposition

- ☐ Outpatient therapy appropriate
- ☐ Further assessment needed
- ☐ Referral / higher level of care